

Message

03 · MESSAGING

Confused people do not buy. Resonance over persuasion.

THE HERO AND THE GUIDE

Gandalf does not carry the ring. Frodo does. Your client is the hero of this story; you are the guide who has been down the road before.

THE MISTAKE THAT COSTS THE MOST

Casting yourself as the hero. Fifteen years of experience, three qualifications, here is my philosophy. All true, all pointed at the wrong person. A reader is looking for themselves; when they find your credentials instead, they respect you and they leave. Your experience is a supporting note, never the headline.

THE FIVE THINGS EVERY MESSAGE NEEDS

The hero	Who this is for, specifically enough that one person recognizes themselves
Their pain points	Plural. The practical problem, how it makes them feel, and the sense that it is wrong they should put up with it
The desired outcome	Specific enough to picture an ordinary Tuesday inside it
The obstacles	What has stopped them, including what they have already tried
The cost of inaction	Where this goes in three months, a year, five years — said honestly

THE VEHICLE BETWEEN THE TWO

Where they are now, and where they want to be. Your program is the vehicle between the two — that is what positions it. Name both ends precisely and the offer explains itself.

EVERYBODY WITH A GOAL IS THE SAME

They know where they want to be. Something is in the way. They have tried and stalled. And part of them has started to believe it might not happen. Your job is to ignite the spark, then show them the way.

THE FORMULA

I work with [ideal clients] who [specific problem] so that they can [desired outcome].

THE TEST OF A GOOD PAIN PHRASE

Not “stress” but “answers email at eleven at night and feels guilty either way”. Specific, felt, and slightly uncomfortable to read.

TAKE THE CLINICAL VOCABULARY OUT

Presenting, ruminating, dysregulated, processing. Those words belong to the other lane and they tell a reader they are being assessed rather than understood.

THE ANNOUNCEMENT – ONE MESSAGE, TOLD AS NEWS

“As you know, I’ve been a therapist for [x] years and I love what I do. Alongside that, I’m excited to tell you I’m now using that experience to launch a coaching program for [group] who want to [transformation]. Do you know anyone who might be interested in this?” One message to everyone. Sharing news rather than asking for a sale — so there is nothing to decline, and the closing question is one anybody can answer. A good number of people reply saying: that sounds like me.